

THE JOYFUL BIRTH PLAN



Prepared by Demo Mom

EXPECTED DUE DATE

March 18, 2027

BIRTH SETTING

Hospital

LOCATION

Austin TX

A letter to my healthcare team — my preferences, my voice, my plan.

SECTION 1 · ABOUT ME & MY PREFERENCES

MOTHER'S NAME

Demo Mom

PARTNER'S NAME (IF APPLICABLE)

Dana Kohler

EMAIL ADDRESS

—

PHONE NUMBER

—

DUE DATE

March 18, 2027

BIRTH SUPPORT (AND RELATIONSHIP)

Dana (partner), Maria (sister), Amara Rose (doula)

DOCTOR/MIDWIFE NAME

Dr. Reyes, OB (Seton NW)

WHERE DO YOU PLAN TO GIVE BIRTH?

☒ Hospital

☐ Birth Center

☐ Home Birth

☐ Not sure yet

HOSPITAL/BIRTH CENTER NAME (IF APPLICABLE)

Seton Northwest, Austin

SECTION 2 · LABOR & DELIVERY PREFERENCES

LABOR ENVIRONMENT PREFERENCES

☐ Dim lighting☐ Quiet atmosphere☐ Music playing☐ Aromatherapy☐ Limited visitors☐ Freedom to move around☐ Access to shower/tub☐ Birth ball available

WHAT WOULD YOU LIKE TO WEAR DURING LABOR?

☐ Hospital gown☐ My own clothes/gown☐ Birthing skirt☐ No preference

LABOR POSITIONS YOU WANT TO TRY

☐ Walking☐ Standing☐ Squatting☒ Hands and knees☐ Side lying☐ Using birth ball☐ In water/tub☐ Whatever feels right

FOOD AND DRINK DURING LABOR

☐ Clear liquids only☐ Light snacks if allowed☐ Ice chips only☐ Whatever is permitted

WHO WOULD YOU LIKE PRESENT DURING LABOR?

Dana and Amara only; medical staff as needed

PHOTOGRAPHY/VIDEO PREFERENCES

- ☐ Photos during labor
- ☐ Photos during delivery
- ☐ Video during labor
- ☐ Video during delivery
- ☐ No photos or video
- ☐ Photos of baby only after birth

OVERALL APPROACH TO PAIN MANAGEMENT

- ☐ I prefer to avoid medication if possible
- ☐ I am open to medication if needed
- ☐ I plan to use an epidural
- ☐ I want to decide during labor

NON-MEDICATION PAIN RELIEF METHODS

- ☐ Breathing techniques
- ☐ Massage
- ☐ Counter-pressure
- ☐ Hydrotherapy (shower/tub)
- ☐ TENS unit
- ☐ Birthing ball
- ☐ Position changes
- ☐ Aromatherapy
- ☐ Hypnobirthing techniques
- ☐ Meditation/visualization
- ☐ Hot/cold compresses

FETAL MONITORING PREFERENCE

- ☐ Intermittent monitoring (more freedom to move)
- ☐ Continuous monitoring
- ☐ Wireless/waterproof monitoring if available
- ☐ Whatever is medically recommended

IV/HEP-LOCK PREFERENCE

- ☐ Hep-lock only (no fluids unless needed)
- ☐ IV fluids
- ☐ No IV unless medically necessary
- ☐ Whatever is recommended

EPISIOTOMY PREFERENCES

- ☐ Prefer to tear naturally
- ☐ Okay if necessary to prevent tearing
- ☐ Only in emergency
- ☐ Please discuss with me

IF CESAREAN BECOMES NECESSARY

- ☐ Partner present in OR
- ☐ Clear drape to see baby born
- ☐ Immediate skin-to-skin if possible
- ☐ Delayed cord clamping if possible
- ☐ Music in operating room
- ☐ Narrate what is happening
- ☐ Lower the drape at birth

PUSHING APPROACH

- ☐ Spontaneous pushing (push when I feel the urge)
- ☐ Directed/coached pushing
- ☐ Laboring down (wait for urge)
- ☐ Whatever feels right

PUSHING POSITIONS TO TRY

- ☐ Semi-reclined
- ☐ Side lying
- ☐ Squatting
- ☐ Hands and knees
- ☐ Using squat bar
- ☐ Standing
- ☐ In water
- ☐ Whatever works best

SECTION 3 · PAIN MANAGEMENT

MEDICATION OPTIONS (IF NEEDED)

- ☐ IV pain medication
- ☐ Epidural
- ☐ Spinal block
- ☐ Local anesthesia
- ☐ Nitrous oxide (laughing gas)
- ☐ Please discuss all options with me first

IF YOU CHOOSE AN EPIDURAL

- ☐ Light/walking epidural if available
- ☐ Full epidural
- ☐ I want to wait as long as possible
- ☐ Please offer when appropriate
- ☐ Do not offer unless I ask

SECTION 4 · LABOR ENVIRONMENT & COMFORT

VAGINAL EXAMS

- ☐ Only when necessary
- ☐ Frequent updates on progress
- ☐ Please ask before each exam
- ☐ Minimal exams preferred

ARTIFICIAL RUPTURE OF MEMBRANES (BREAKING WATER)

- ☐ Allow to happen naturally
- ☐ Okay to speed up labor
- ☐ Please discuss with me first
- ☐ Only if medically necessary

COMFORT MEASURES AVAILABLE

- ☐ Birth ball
- ☐ Peanut ball
- ☐ Rocking chair
- ☐ Birth stool
- ☐ Squat bar
- ☐ Warm compresses
- ☐ Cold compresses
- ☐ Fan or cool cloth

SECTION 5 · PUSHING, DELIVERY & SAFE WORD

WOULD YOU LIKE TO USE A MIRROR?

- ☐ Yes, I want to see
- ☐ No, I do not want to see
- ☐ Maybe, I will decide then

WOULD YOU LIKE TO TOUCH BABY?

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PERINEAL SUPPORT PREFERENCES

- ☐ Warm compresses
- ☐ Perineal massage
- ☐ Oil/lubricant
- ☐ Hands-off approach
- ☐ Trust provider\

SAFE WORD (FOR COMMUNICATION WITH YOUR TEAM)

Sunflower

WHAT SHOULD HAPPEN WHEN YOU USE YOUR SAFE WORD?

Pause everything and give us a moment alone

SECTION 6 · POST-DELIVERY PREFERENCES

IMMEDIATE SKIN-TO-SKIN

- ☐ Yes, immediately after birth
- ☐ After baby is briefly assessed
- ☐ Partner does skin-to-skin first
- ☐ Flexible based on circumstances

CORD CLAMPING

- ☐ Delayed cord clamping (wait until cord stops pulsing)
- ☐ Delayed 1-3 minutes
- ☐ Immediate clamping
- ☐ Whatever is recommended

WHO WOULD YOU LIKE TO CUT THE CORD?

- ☐ Partner
- ☐ Mother
- ☐ Doctor/Midwife
- ☐ No preference

CORD BLOOD BANKING

- ☐ Private cord blood banking
- ☐ Public cord blood donation
- ☐ Not banking cord blood
- ☐ Still deciding

PLACENTA PREFERENCES

- ☐ See the placenta
- ☐ Take placenta home
- ☐ Placenta encapsulation
- ☐ No special requests

GOLDEN HOUR PREFERENCES

- ☐ Uninterrupted skin-to-skin for at least one hour
- ☐ Delay routine procedures
- ☐ Breastfeed within first hour
- ☐ Dim lights in room
- ☐ Quiet environment
- ☐ Limit visitors
- ☐ Photos welcome

ANNOUNCING BABY\

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BABY'S FIRST BATH

- ☐ Delay 24+ hours
- ☐ Delay 8-12 hours
- ☐ After initial bonding period
- ☐ Parent wants to give first bath
- ☐ Standard hospital timing

EYE PROPHYLAXIS (ERYTHROMYCIN)

- ☐ Yes, administer
- ☐ Delay 1 hour for bonding
- ☐ Decline (discuss with provider)
- ☐ Follow hospital protocol

VITAMIN K

- ☐ Yes, injection
- ☐ Oral vitamin K
- ☐ Decline (discuss with provider)
- ☐ Follow hospital protocol

FEEDING PLAN

- ☐ Exclusive breastfeeding
- ☐ Breastfeeding with supplementation if needed
- ☐ Formula feeding
- ☐ Combination feeding
- ☐ Still deciding

ROOMING IN

- ☐ Baby stays with me 24/7
- ☐ Baby goes to nursery at night
- ☐ Flexible based on my needs

POSTPARTUM SUPPORT PLANS

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SECTION 7 · NEWBORN CARE PREFERENCES

WHERE SHOULD BABY\

In my room, on my chest if possible

VERNIX (WHITE COATING)

- ☐ Leave on - let it absorb naturally
- ☐ Gently wipe off
- ☐ Standard cleaning

HEPATITIS B VACCINE

- ☐ Yes, administer before discharge
- ☐ Delay until pediatrician visit
- ☐ Decline (discuss with provider)
- ☐ Still deciding

CIRCUMCISION (IF APPLICABLE)

- ☐ Yes, during hospital stay
- ☐ Yes, with pediatrician later
- ☐ No circumcision
- ☐ Not applicable

PACIFIER USE

- ☐ No pacifiers
- ☐ Okay after breastfeeding established
- ☐ Okay from the start
- ☐ As needed for procedures

SECTION 8 · OTHER IMPORTANT CONSIDERATIONS

CULTURAL OR RELIGIOUS CONSIDERATIONS

Blessing ceremony planned — please allow a quiet window

PREVIOUS BIRTH EXPERIENCES TO CONSIDER

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SPECIAL ANXIETIES OR CONCERNS

I am anxious about losing my voice in the room; please check in with me directly

MEDICAL CONDITIONS OR ALLERGIES

Latex allergy

EMERGENCY CONTACT (BESIDES PARTNER)

Maria (sister) (512) 555-0142

MUSIC PREFERENCES

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